Introductory Note

1. Ms. Aisshwarya DKS Hegde, National Education Foundation, Bengaluru

Ms. Aisshwarya DKS Hegde is Trustee Secretary of the National Education Foundation (NEF), Bengaluru. NEF runs the Global Academy of Technology (GAT), an autonomous engineering and management college affiliated to VTU, together with National Hill View Public School and the Global College of Nursing. A management graduate, she leads the academic and administrative work of these institutions, and she speaks regularly to students on preparation, perseverance and the value of education. She is the eldest daughter of Sri D.K. Shivakumar, Hon'ble Chief Minister of Karnataka.

2. Mr. K. Vijay, Founder and Chairman, Ajax Engineering Pvt. Ltd.

Mr. K. Vijay is an alumnus of IIT Madras and began his career with Larsen & Toubro in Mumbai and Bengaluru. He went on to found Ajax Engineering, which introduced Self-Loading Concrete Mixers to India thirty years ago and is today a global leader in the field. The company has five factories in Doddaballapur and Gauribidanur, employs more than 1,200 people directly and supports over 3,500 indirect jobs. Mr. Vijay has led the company's work on patents and has served as Vice President of ICEMA, the industry body for construction equipment. He is actively engaged in philanthropy, both through Ajax and in his personal capacity.

3. Ms. Shaina, Outreach Lead, Embassy Group

Ms. Shaina leads the outreach initiatives of Embassy Group. Founded in 1993, the Group is one of India's leading real estate developers, with more than 100 million sq. ft. developed across over 22 cities. She regards strong education and health infrastructure as central to nation-building. Under her leadership, Embassy's programmes span child development, healthcare, skill development, career guidance and pathways to employment. Through the Corporate Connect Programme, she brings companies and leaders together for community development, in line with the Group's ESG and SDG commitments.

4. Little Rock Indian School (LRIS), Brahmavar, Udupi

Little Rock Indian School is a co-educational, CBSE-affiliated day-cum-boarding school founded in 1982 by the late Dr. C.T. Abraham. Located on a 30-acre campus in Chanthar Village, Brahmavar, it has more than 3,450 students and about 175 teachers. IIRF ranks it fourteenth among schools in India for its Board results, teaching, infrastructure and care of students.